

Bridging the Cyber Resiliency Gap:

Why Aligning Cybersecurity Priorities is Critical for Business Resilience



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Executive Summary

The strategic disconnect: More than 70% of organizations report a gap between cybersecurity strategy and business priorities.

Businesses recognize cybersecurity as a core enterprise risk, with 94% recognizing it as a primary threat and nearly half naming it their top concern. Boards discuss it, CEOs own it and regulators expect it.

To assess exactly how organizations are responding to cyber threats, Kroll engaged Sapio Research to survey 1,000 cybersecurity decision-makers across 10 countries. The respondents represent companies with annual revenue that ranges from USD 50 million to more than USD 5 billion. More than 90% consider cyberattacks a primary threat and nearly half say it is their top concern.

Notably, 48% of respondents state that the CEO now makes the final call on cyber budgets. Leadership owns the risk; strategy must keep pace. However, more than 70% report a gap between cybersecurity strategy and business priorities:

- Thirty-six percent acknowledge gaps in how threats are prioritized.
- Seventy-two percent say cybersecurity decisions frequently diverge from broader business priorities.
- The leading reported causes of misalignment between leadership and IT are differing risk tolerance (51%) and limited cyber literacy among executives (43%).

Even as CEOs and cyber leaders begin to “speak the same language,” the gap between strategic intent and operational execution is widening. This disconnect is slowing progress at the very moment organizations must accelerate, because cybersecurity threats are evolving faster than governance structures, decision-making processes, and risk frameworks can keep up.

The impact of these threats is tangible. A single cyber incident can disrupt operations, stall growth initiatives and expose organizations to material losses. Yearly recovery costs and downtime alone cost an average USD 2.2 mn. Total financial impacts for businesses can be even more substantial, as evidenced by 2025 news headlines. For example, UnitedHealth Group's (U.S.) 2025 earnings materials highlight USD 799 mn of “final cyberattack costs” (the impact to 2025 earnings before taxes)¹.

Similarly, our report shows that the average financial impact of cyber threats is greater than USD 20.9 mn, highlighting the material scale of cyber risk.

Because cyber threats have become more frequent and more sophisticated, and have been amplified by rapid AI adoption, closing the strategy-operations gap is no longer optional.



72%

surveyed decision-makers reporting
frequent misalignment between
security and business priorities



\$20 mn

average financial
impact of a
cyber incident

¹ UnitedHealth Group, UnitedHealth Group Reports 2025 Results and Issues 2026 Outlook, n.d., <https://www.unitedhealthgroup.com/content/dam/UHG/PDF/investors/2025/unh-reports-2025-results-and-issues-2026-outlook.pdf>

In the News: The Largest Cyberattacks of 2025

Nation-State Intrusions Hit Critical Communications²

A major China-linked campaign (Salt Typhoon/Operator Panda) infiltrated leading U.S. telecom carriers, operating undetected inside some of the most hardened networks for months. This attack exposed the fragility of even the most secure nationwide infrastructure.

Retail-Sector Disruption: Coordinated Ransomware Attacks Across Major UK Brands³

Cyberattacks brought severe financial and operational impacts for these retailers. Marks & Spencer suffered four months of downtime and lost all profits following an April attack, while a breach at Jaguar Land Rover halted production for five weeks, caused a 17.1% sales drop and cost £1.9 billion. Beyond these disruptions, organizations faced liquidity strain, covenant risk and insurance uncertainty, and legal teams had to manage breach notifications, vendor liability and complex, regulation-aligned forensic investigations.

IT Distribution Hit: Ingram Micro Ransomware Disruption⁴

A ransomware attack on Ingram Micro, a global IT distribution powerhouse, triggered widespread business disruption and downstream supply chain impacts for customers and partners.

Cybersecurity cannot be reduced to new tools or larger budgets. It requires a clear view of real-world threats, disciplined governance and tested resilience. Without that foundation, technology investments can add complexity without reducing exposure.

48% of respondents report that CEOs make the final call on cyber budget decisions. Corporate leadership owns cyber risk. Their strategies must keep pace with the growing threat.

The survey's findings make clear where the strategy gap is widening. We outline the actions leaders must take to close it.

² Kyle Alspach, "10 Major Cyberattacks and Data Breaches in 2025," December 19, 2025, CRN, <https://www.crn.com/news/security/2025/10-major-cyberattacks-and-data-breaches-in-2025>

³ Brent R. Tomlinson and Dave Burg, "Moving the Needle: Taking Retail Businesses From 'At Risk' to Resilient," February 6, 2026, Kroll, <https://www.kroll.com/en/publications/cyber/retail-businesses-from-at-risk-to-resilient>

⁴ Steven Burke, "Ingram Micro Hit by SafePay Ransomware Attack: Report," July 5, 2025, CRN, <https://www.crn.com/news/security/2025/ingram-micro-hit-by-safepay-ransomware-attack-report>

Key Findings



Disconnect Between Corporate Strategy and Security Execution

- Ninety-four percent of respondents view cybersecurity as a core or top risk, with nearly half (48%) citing cyber concerns as their leading risk.
- Businesses are most concerned about the financial impact (66%) of cyberattacks on their organization. This worry is closely followed by operational impacts (62%).
- Seventy-two percent frequently experience misalignment between business and cybersecurity priorities.



Organizations Overestimate Their Resilience: Recovery Matters as Much as Defense

- Ninety-six percent of respondents say that their companies have quantified the financial impact of cyber risks.
- Thirty-six percent say their business falls in the middle of the pack regarding cyber maturity (companies with very high maturity incur roughly half the financial impact per USD 1 mn of revenue, compared with low-maturity organizations).
- Ninety-one percent of respondents believe their company can respond to a cyber incident in at least 24 hours. (But attacks can spread in just 29 minutes.)



The Investment Paradox: Cyber Budgets Are Rising, but Priorities Don't Match Today's Threat Landscape

- Eighty percent of respondents say their companies increased their 2026 cybersecurity budgets.
- The bulk of cyber investment goes toward technology: 59% of respondents say their companies increased spending for cloud and third-party security.
- Yet the most common risks come from human-focused mechanisms; 67% of cyberattacks are identity-centric (e.g., phishing).



AI Could Be a Force Multiplier When Cybersecurity Has a Solid Foundation

- Proof that AI use is growing exponentially, 76% of respondents experienced a security incident involving AI applications or models in the last year.
- Forty-eight percent stated they had little to no organizational governance on AI tool and service adoption.
- Organizations spend an average of only 13% of their AI initiative budget on using AI to test security controls or to test the models themselves.

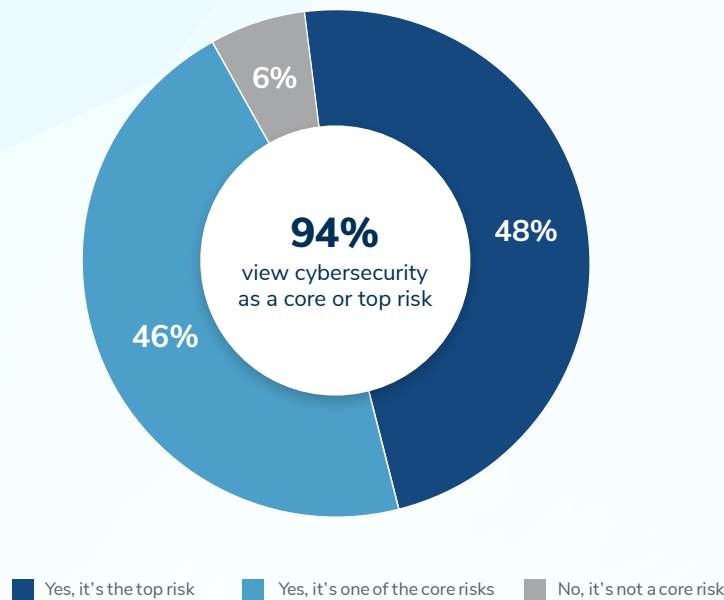


The Path Forward: Back to Basics to Prepare for What's Next

- Ninety-nine percent of respondents say their business has an incident response plan, but just 3% update their plans after a cyber incident.
- Forty-four percent say their businesses lack clarity on their cyber insurance coverage and requirements.

1. Bridging the Disconnect Between Corporate Strategy and Cybersecurity Execution

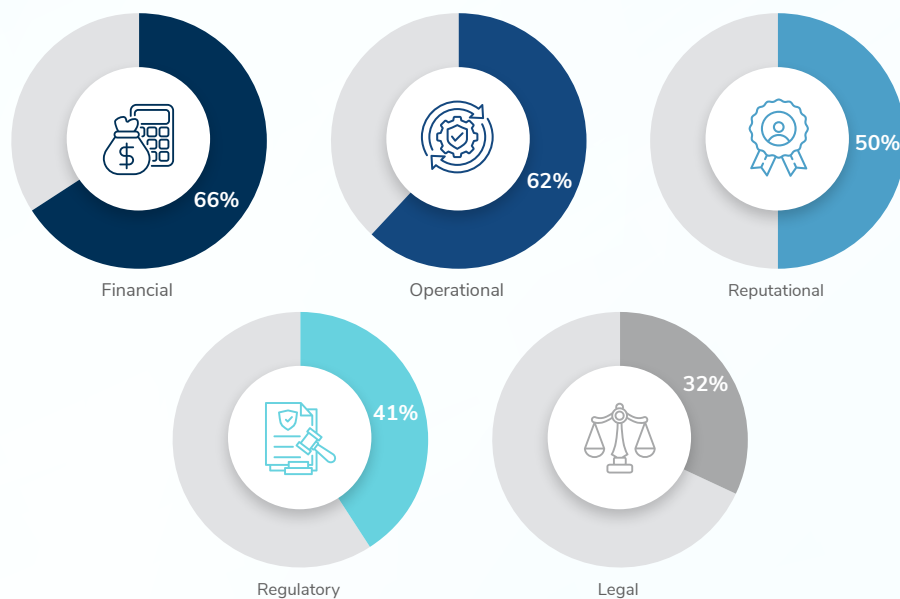
Businesses now see cybersecurity as an ever-present threat: 94% of respondents viewing cybersecurity as a core or top risk.



Base: 1000

Q. Is cybersecurity viewed by your enterprise as a core risk to your business?

Fallout from attacks is top of mind, with 66% of respondents saying their businesses are concerned about financial loss and 62% reporting worry regarding operational downtime.

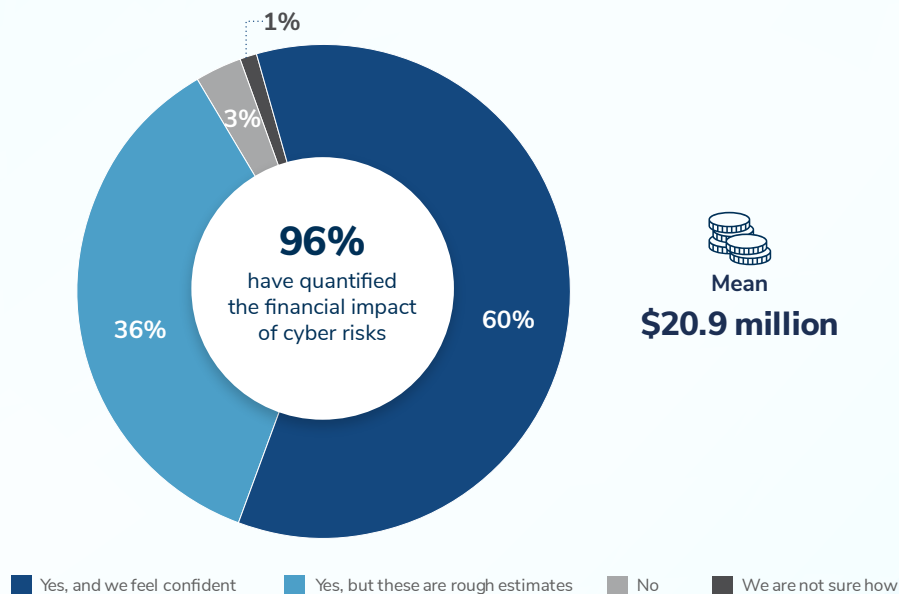


Base: 1000

Q. Which types of impact from a cyberattack are most concerning to your business? Select up to three

Executive Alignment Is Improving, but Cyber Readiness Is Not

Companies now treat cybersecurity as a measurable business risk. Nearly all organizations represented (96%) have quantified their cyber risk, with potential losses averaging USD 20.9 mn, a figure that underscores the urgency for better resilience.



Base: 1000

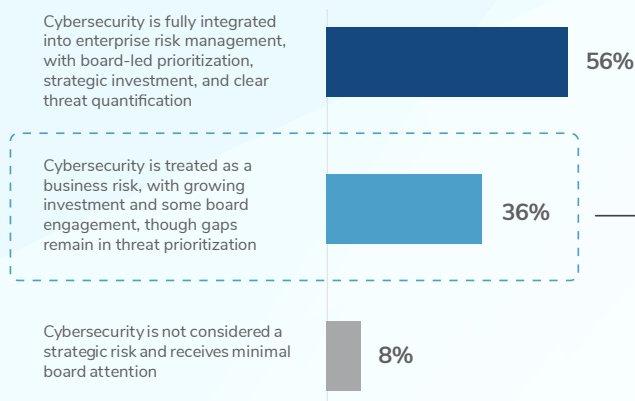
Q. Have you quantified the financial impact of cyber risks on your business? Select one

However, it appears that few companies have cracked the code on effective alignment. Organizations continue to struggle with mismatched priorities: Security teams focus on defense and recovery, CEOs juggle operational impacts and boards stress compliance and spending limits. In the gaps are vulnerabilities that attackers are all too willing to exploit.

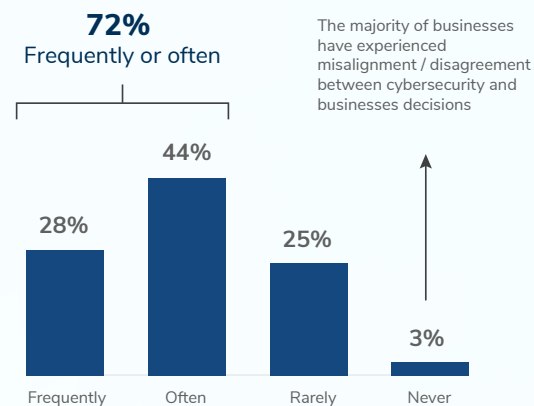
Nearly half (44%) of respondents do not experience fully aligned cybersecurity strategies and risk management practices at their organizations. What's more, 72% frequently experience misalignment between business and cybersecurity priorities.



How well aligned is your organization's cybersecurity strategy with risk management priorities?



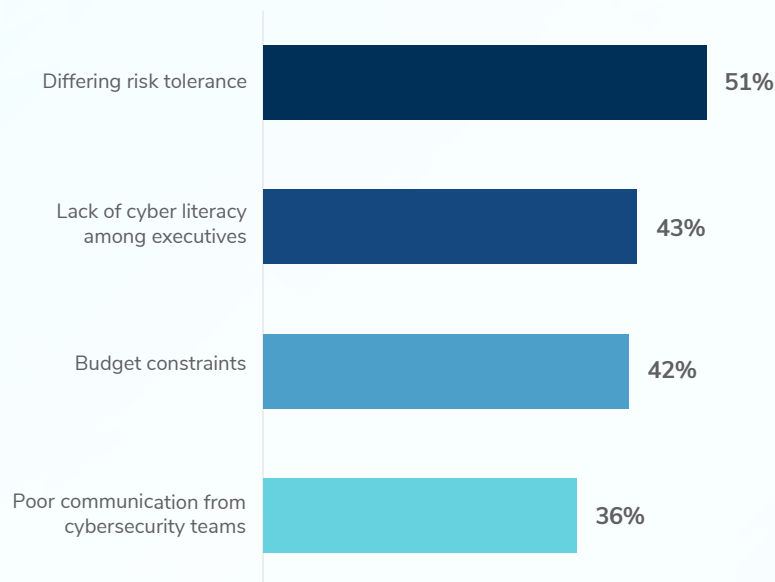
How often have you experienced misalignment or disagreement between cybersecurity priorities and business priorities?



Base: 1000

Respondents attribute the disconnect between executive strategy and security execution to differing risk tolerance (51%) and limited cyber literacy among executives (43%). Even though CEOs and cyber leaders are beginning to speak the same language, alignment gaps impede preparation for the threats of today and tomorrow.





Base: *966

Q. What were the main causes of misalignment or disagreement? Select up to two

*Asked to those who have experienced misalignment between cybersecurity priorities and business priorities

When leaders and security teams define risk differently, mitigation efforts and resource allocation fall out of step with operational realities. That gap creates unnecessary exposure, because the cybersecurity budget may not actually reflect the nature of the company's threats.

Actionable Insights

Security executives and chief information security officers (CISOs) can close the strategic disconnect between business goals and cybersecurity priorities by taking a more intentional, business-aligned approach:

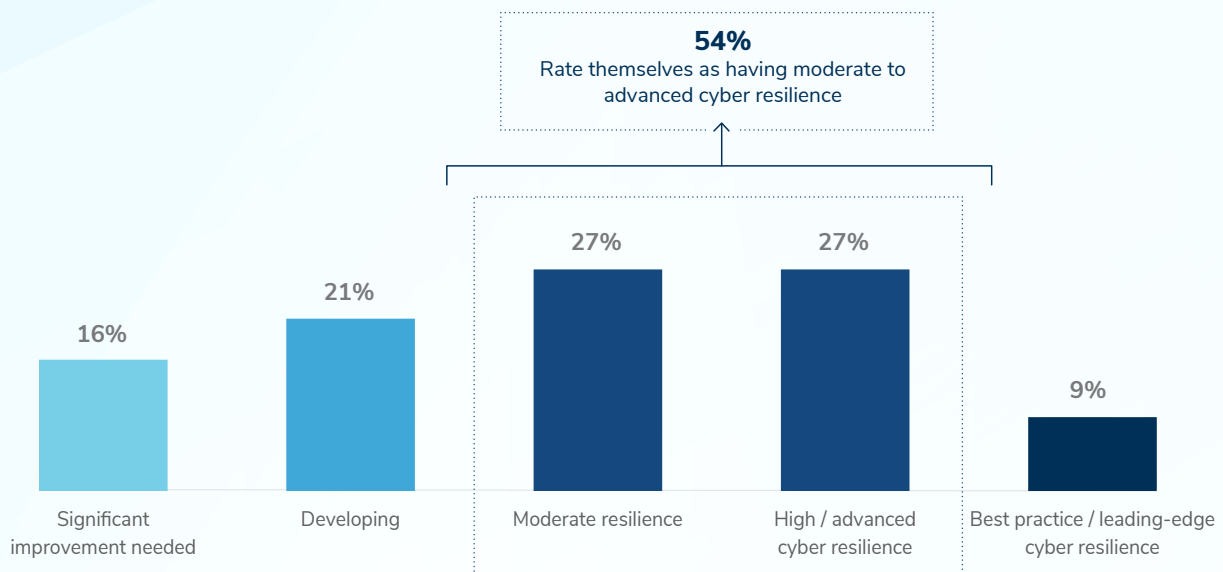
- ✓ Begin by framing cybersecurity as an enterprise risk, translating threats into clear operational and financial impacts that resonate with executives.
- ✓ Establish alignment through a focused cyber strategy and road map that links security investments to the organization's most important objectives.
- ✓ Use targeted assessments and security reviews to identify gaps; then prioritize actions that deliver the greatest risk reduction.
- ✓ Ensure effective execution by designing the architecture and configuring tools to fit the environment and focusing on resilience.

These steps enable CISOs to clarify communication, accelerate progress and position cybersecurity as a strategic enabler of long-term business success.

2. Organizations Overestimate Their Resilience: Recovery Matters as Much as Defense

On the surface, most companies seem prepared to handle the financial (66%) and operational (62%) cyberattack consequences they're concerned about: 99% of respondents say their company has an incident response plan.

But cybersecurity is a continual process: Threat actors are always getting better at evading defenses, and there is always a chance employees will download shadow IT or click links that look convincingly real. Over the past two years, U.S. business downtime and recovery costs averaged USD 2.2 mn, highlighting a gap between belief and reality regarding cyber resilience. Cyber maturity plays a role in such expenses: For less mature organizations, recovery and downtime can be a significant financial burden, approximately two and a half times the cost per USD 1 mn of revenue of a company with a highly maturity program.



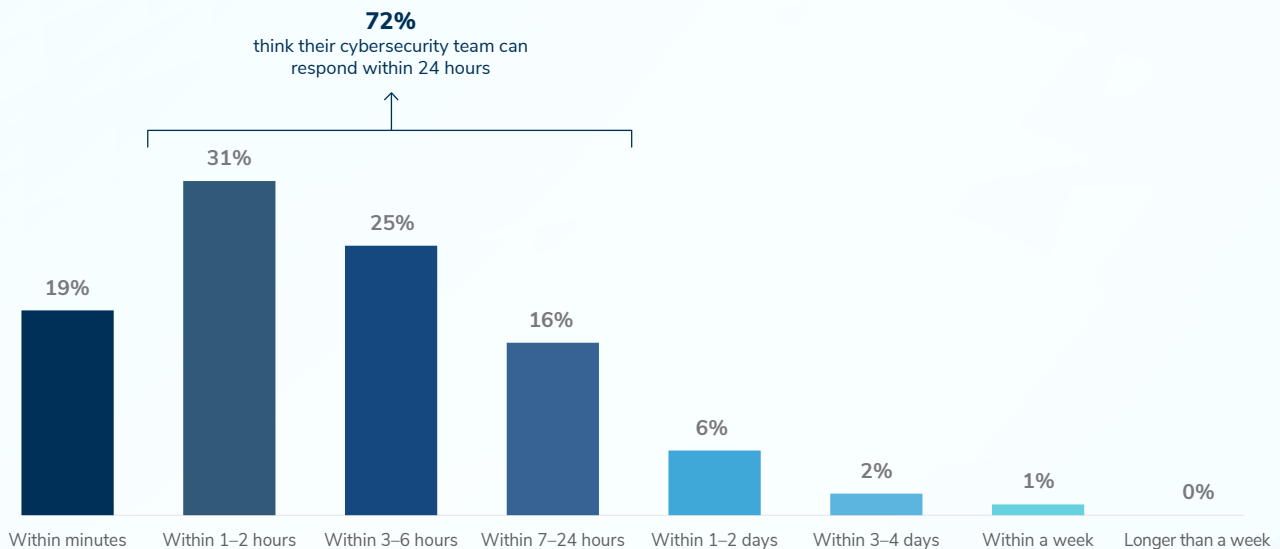
Base: 1000

Q. How would you rate your organization's cyber resilience?

More than half of the survey respondents (54%) rate their companies as moderately or highly resilient. Keep in mind that overconfidence can be dangerous, given the speed and scale of threats, especially AI-enabled ones.

Independent benchmarks suggest a less rosy picture. The NIST maturity assessments frequently show that organizations fall short of their own defined security standards.





Base: 1000

Q. How quickly do you think your cybersecurity team can respond to indications of a sophisticated, serious attack?

The difference between perceived and demonstrated resilience can be significant: Only 19% of respondents believe their company can respond to an incident within minutes, yet a recent report show that the average e-crime breakout time in 2025 was 29 minutes.⁵ That is a 65% increase in speed compared with 2024. The same report noted that the fastest breakout time ever recorded was 27 seconds.

Therefore, significant damage can be done before cyber defenders can mount a response.



The window between intrusion and impact is a fraction of most companies' response times.

⁵CrowdStrike, CrowdStrike 2026 Global Threat Report, n.d.,
<https://www.crowdstrike.com/en-us/global-threat-report/>

“Breakout time” is the interval between an intruder’s initial access and their first lateral movement.

Belief that a company is “ready for anything” can cause company leadership to miss potential threats or shift their attention to other pressing business issues. The opposite also holds true: If you are continually aware of how at risk you are, you might be more likely to think you are less prepared.

Cyber readiness is built on governance, discipline and tested fundamentals, not just technology acceleration, and recovery and resilience involve more than returning the business to its previous state. They also involve quickly and effectively containing the damage, restoring operations and learning from the event.

Actionable Insights

Readiness requires the entire organization to be aware of potential threats and their role in securing against them.

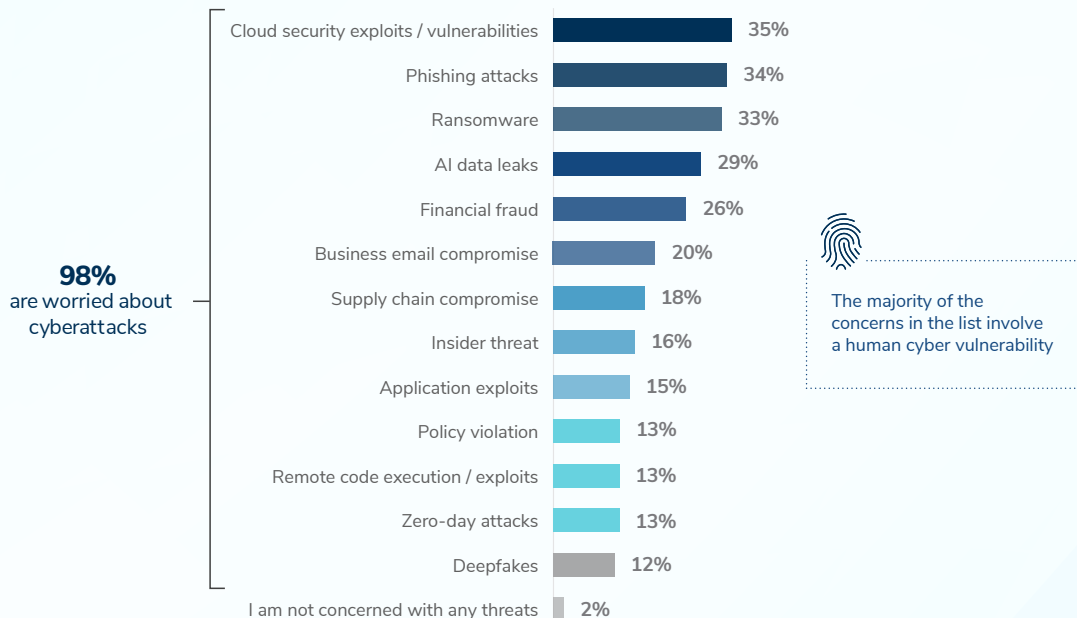
- ✓ As AI accelerates cyber threats and expands third-party exposure, security leaders must counter organizational overconfidence with transparent, data-driven risk narratives.
- ✓ Fewer than one in 10 companies believe they have cutting-edge resilience capabilities. CISOs should guide their organizations to upgrade capabilities as needed, including advanced automation and streamlined response procedures.
- ✓ Resilience comes from continuously monitoring, measuring and identifying new threats and their impact on operations. Threats can evolve at breakneck speed; CISOs and the C-suite need to review and refine practices regularly and adapt to changing conditions without delay.

Awareness is a risk factor and an opportunity. By digging deeper to truly understanding the threat landscape and the organization’s recovery capability, security and business leaders can align priorities and quickly improve their security posture.



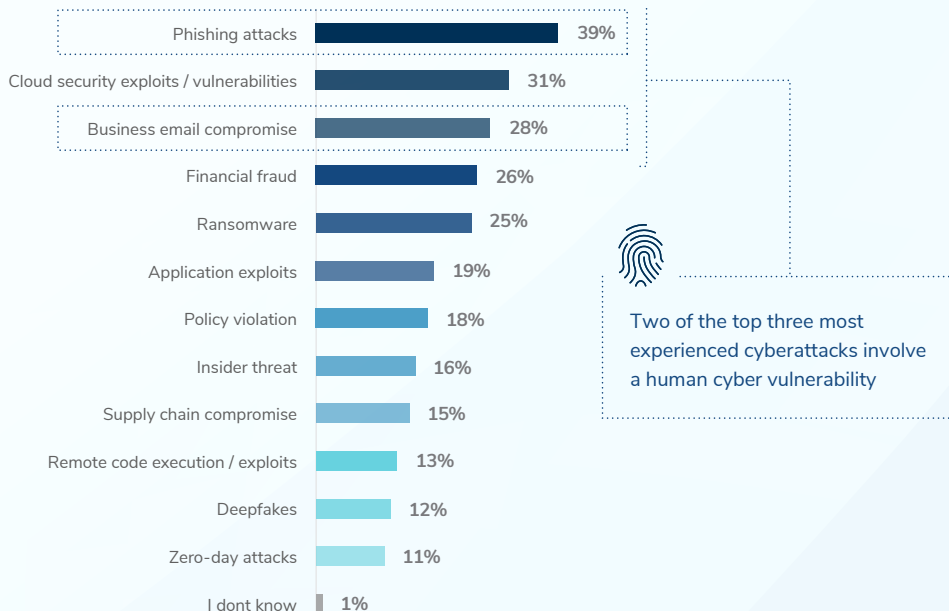
3. The Investment Paradox: Cyber Budgets Are Rising, but Priorities Don't Match Today's Threat Landscape

While nearly all respondents surveyed worry about cyberattacks, leaders disagree on the nature of those risks.



Base: 1000

Q. Which type of cyberattacks worry you most? Select up to three



Base: 1000

Q. Which type of cyberattacks have you experienced the most in your business? Select up to three

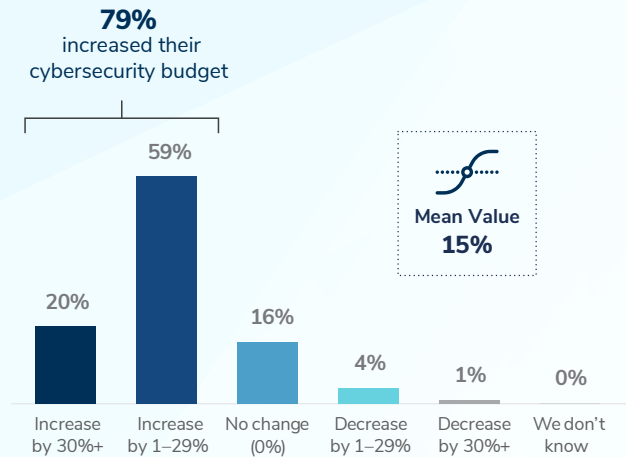
Comparing the top cyber concerns to actual attacks reveals a notable disconnect.

While cloud and application vulnerabilities present real threats, the most frequent attacks continue to target people, credentials and internal processes. Spending patterns reinforce this disconnect. The level of investment versus actual risk leads us to ask, are leaders preparing for the true risks impacting their businesses?

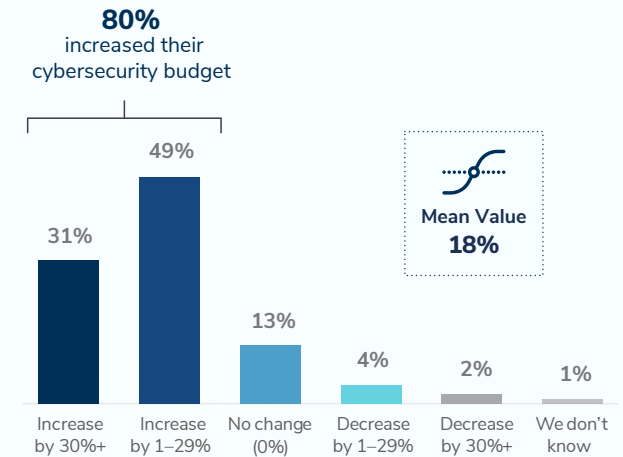
Does More Spending Equal Improved Security?

Eighty percent of respondents state their organizations plan to increase their cybersecurity spending in 2026.

In 2025 compared to 2024



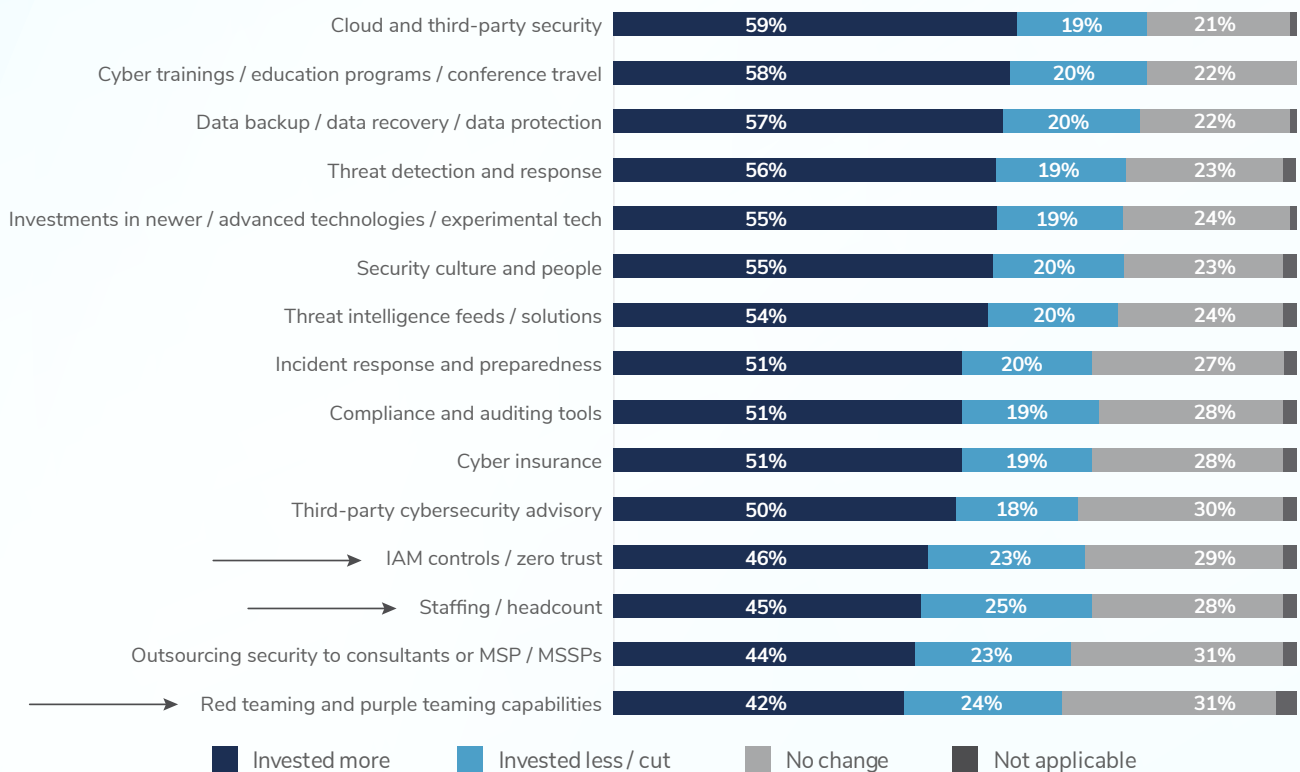
For 2026 compared to 2025



Base: 1000

Q. How has your cybersecurity budget changed in each of the following periods?

How those additional resources are allocated could leave businesses vulnerable. Cloud and third-party security are the focus of this increased spending by 59% of companies, making such security the top concern of businesses. More than half (at least 55%) also invest more in data backup and recovery, threat detection and advanced or experimental technologies.



Base: 1000

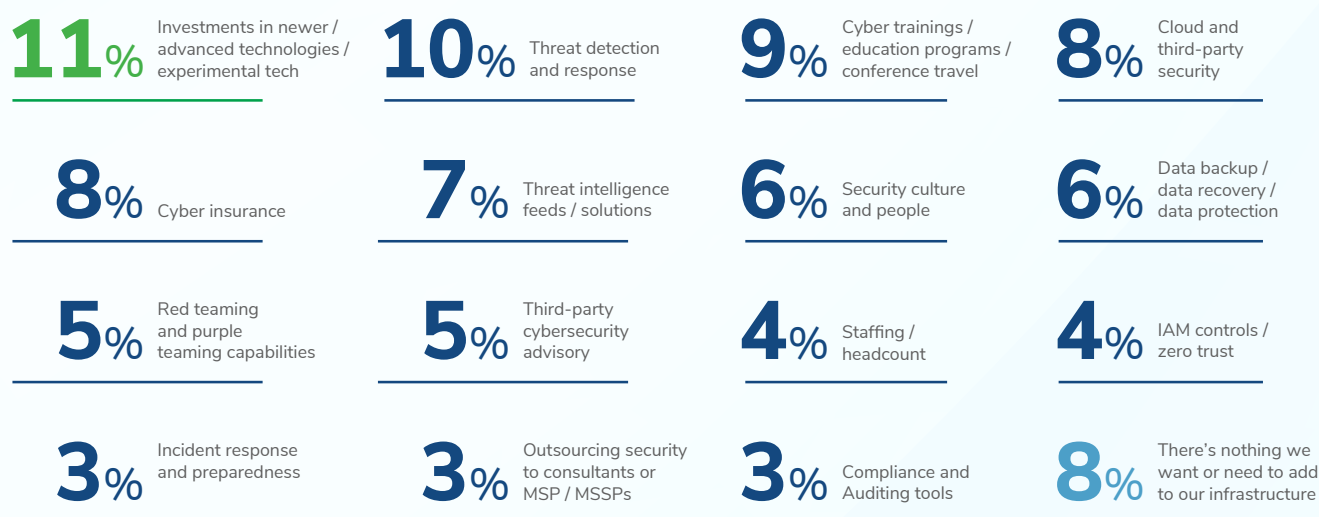
Q. In the last 12 months, how has investment changed in each of the following areas of your cyber program? Select one per row

Organizations mostly invest against the threats they fear, while the most frequent and fastest-growing attacks target people and identity.

Larger budgets, however, do not guarantee a more secure organization if the right tools are not invested in. As a result, foundational security and operational resilience can quickly fall behind. For example:

- Twenty-five percent of companies are cutting head count in 2026.
- Twenty-four percent are cutting red or purple team efforts.
- Twenty-three percent are reducing outsourced security from consultants or managed security service providers.
- Twenty-three percent are cutting their investment in identify and access management controls and zero trust architectures.

Respondents noted that their companies would also most like to add investments in newer and more advanced technologies, which could signal that businesses are not prioritizing the crucial cybersecurity basics that will keep them secure today and in the future.



Base: 1000

Q. What do you not currently have, but would most like to add to your business' cybersecurity program? Select one

One crucial, positive sign: Nearly three out of five (58%) respondents said they are increasing spending on cyber training and education or strengthening security culture and people (55%). This can boost frontline awareness among a shrinking workforce.

Training and a culture of security enable everyone in the organization to act as cyber defenders against phishing, credential theft and identity-based attacks. A united focus is especially important as organizations inject AI across nearly every workflow.

Actionable Insights

Security leaders can resolve today's investment paradox by reframing cyber capability as an operational discipline that demands unified governance, not just bigger budgets.

- ✓ As AI accelerates threat velocity and expands third-party exposure, security leaders must help define risks that are most threatening to business continuity, along with the clearest path to protecting against them.
- ✓ The path forward includes companywide incorporation of security: Standardize processes, embed continuous improvement loops and regularly monitor to ensure measurable, business-relevant insights.
- ✓ To align the strategies of the C-suite, the security team and the board, CISOs should establish a shared risk taxonomy, create joint prioritization forums and tie investment decisions to clearly articulated operational outcomes.

This governance model ensures that funding is not only adequate but strategically directed toward the controls and capabilities that materially reduce enterprise risk.



4. AI Could be a Force Multiplier When Cybersecurity Has a Solid Foundation

AI tools are deeply embedded in many daily business operations: Organizations estimate that 40% of employees use AI tools in their work, and Gartner projects that by 2028⁶, more than 95% of enterprises will have deployed generative AI in production environments

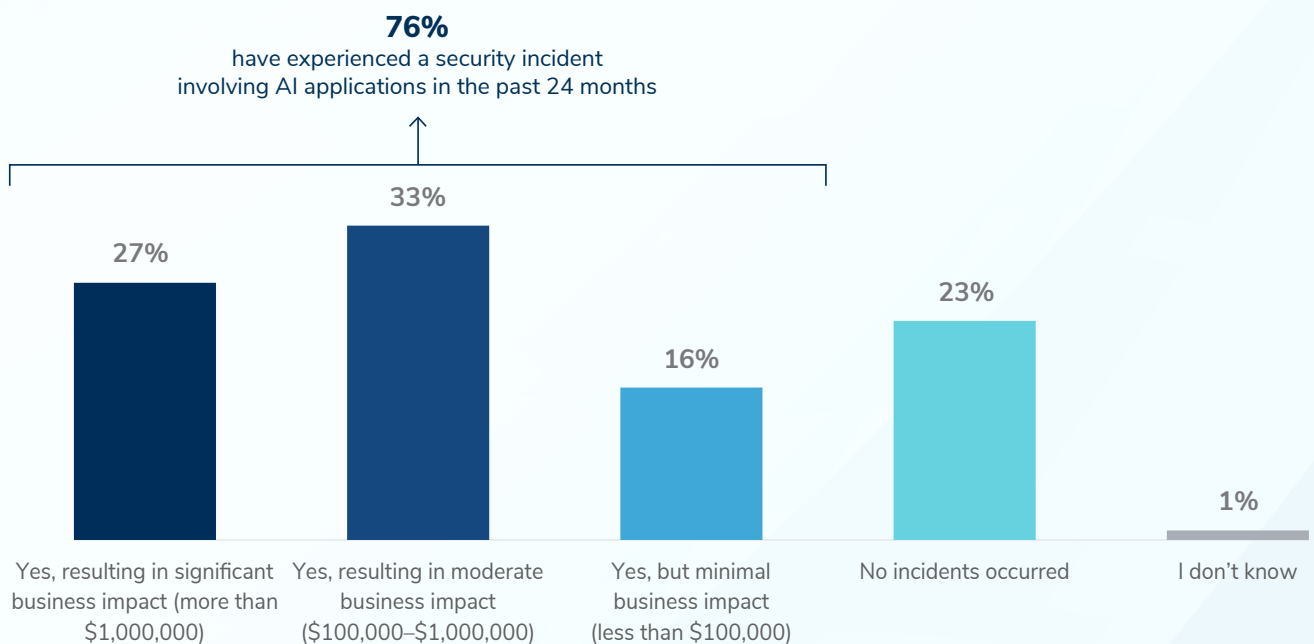
However, hype-driven adoption may be outpacing control. Seventy-six percent of respondents experienced a security incident involving AI applications or models in the last year.

76%

of respondents experienced a security incident involving AI applications or models

27%

of businesses report a cost of over USD 1 million related to AI incidents

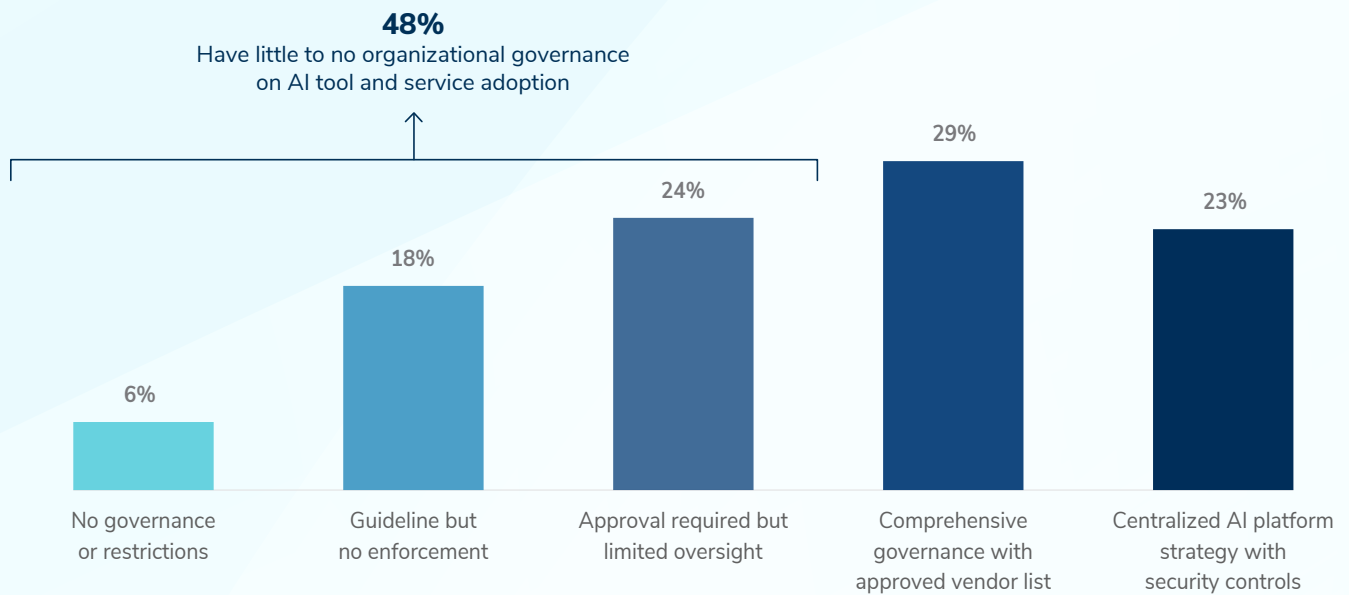


Base: 1000

Q. Has your organization experienced a security incident involving AI applications or models in the past 24 months?

Companies' approved tools are sometimes embedded with AI that is hidden from employees, and these tools coexist with shadow AI. This technology environment can be driving increased security incidents. Forty-eight percent of respondents stated they had little to no organizational governance on AI tool and service adoption, which can result in an expanded attack surface that is not always fully understood.

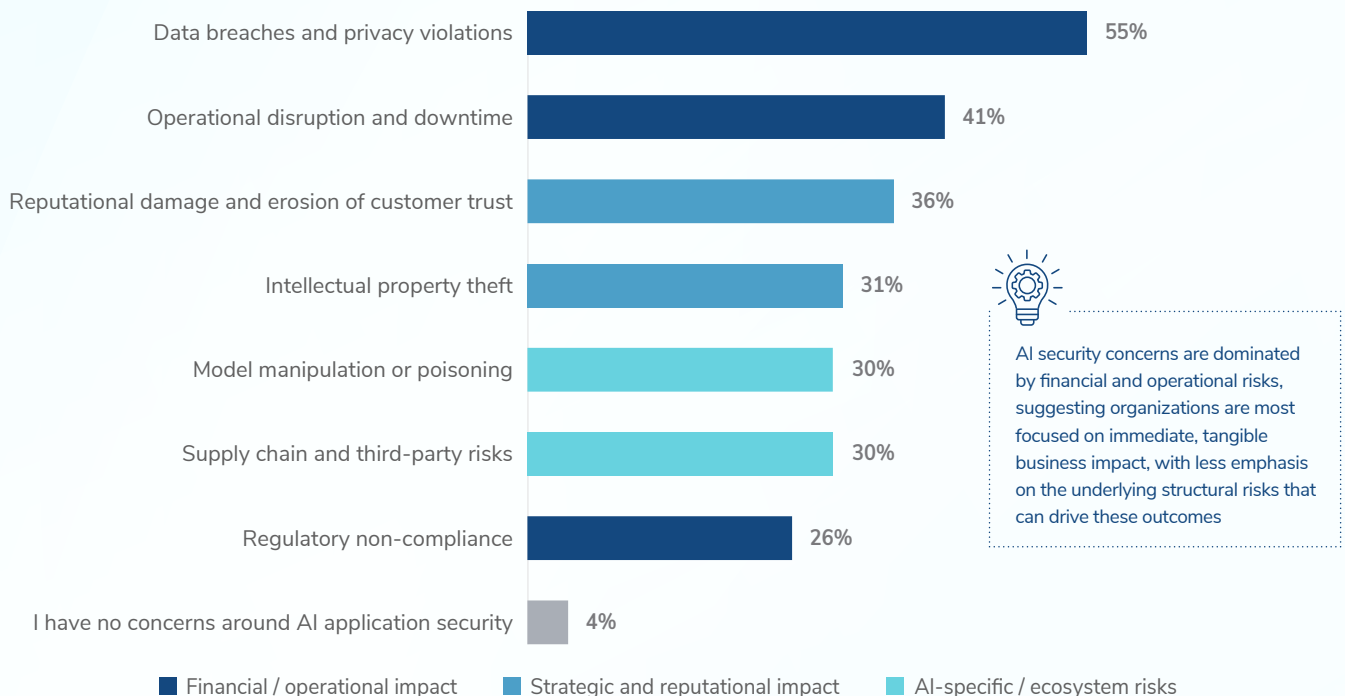
⁶ Arun Chandrasekaran, The 2025 Hype Cycle for GenAI Highlights Critical Innovations, July 29, 2025 Gartner, <https://www.gartner.com/en/articles/hype-cycle-for-genai>



Base: 1000

Q. How does your organization govern employee adoption of AI tools and services? Select one

Of course, businesses are aware of the risks regarding AI application security, with financial and operational risks felt most dominantly.

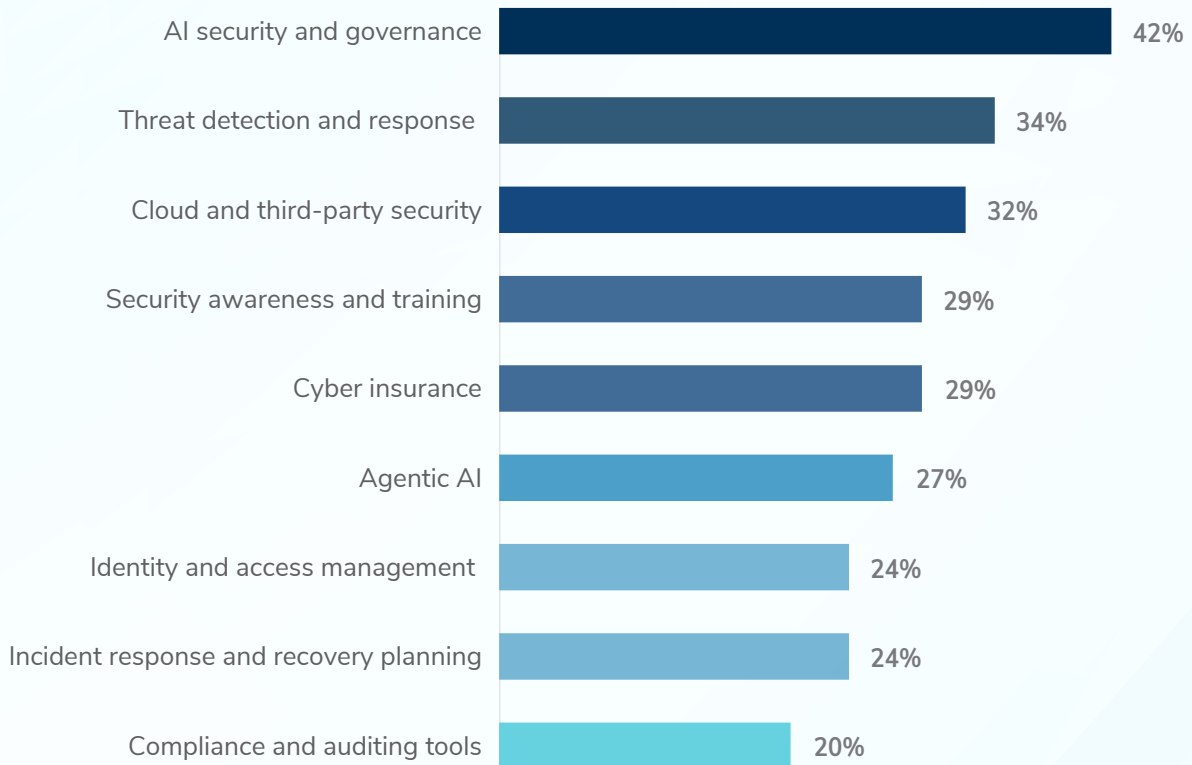


Base: 1000

Q. What business risks concern you most regarding AI application security? Select up to three

To generate ROI from AI investments, companies need to establish security basics. The survey shows that for many respondents' companies, this foundation is still lacking because of misaligned priorities. Such an environment focuses on compliance rather than true security and invests in more tools instead of strategies that account for human nature.

Investment priorities continue to concentrate on AI security and governance, threat detection and response and cloud and third-party security.



Base: 1000

Q. What are your top cybersecurity investment priorities for the next 12–24 months? Select up to three

However, organizations cite budget constraints, talent shortages and competing priorities as roadblocks to effective AI risk management.



Base: 1000

Q. What are your top cybersecurity investment priorities for the next 12–24 months? Select up to three

Cyber Maturity Is Crucial for AI ROI

Creating business value from AI demands a secure operational environment. But many companies lack the cyber maturity to deploy AI securely and effectively.

Organizations that have cyber maturity get the basics right first and then expand and enhance their cyber defenses to meet the evolving needs of the business. Simply buying AI-powered security, for example, does not automatically reduce exposure. Without governance, training and disciplined security fundamentals, AI additions increase complexity faster than value.

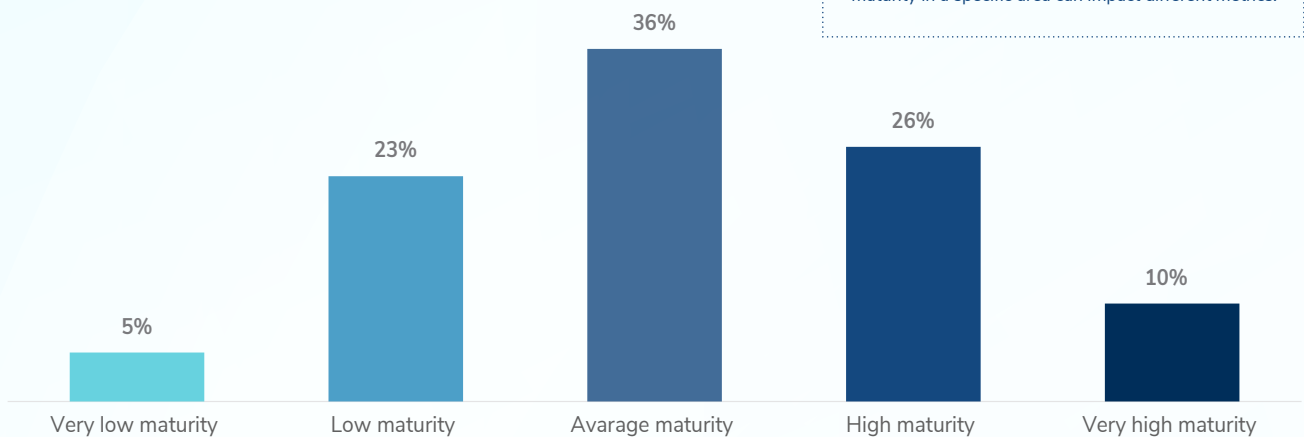
At companies with high to very high cyber maturity, cybersecurity is fully integrated into enterprise risk management and is more likely to be prioritized at the board level.

46%

of businesses with very high cyber maturity report having no security incidents involving AI applications or models in the past two years

What is a maturity model?

A **maturity model** is a framework that helps to evaluate the current capabilities of organizations in a specific area and identify opportunities for improvement. It breaks progress into clear levels, from basic to advanced, and can be used to map out how maturity in a specific area can impact different metrics.



Base: 1000

Q: Maturity model depicting actual cybersecurity resilience maturity of the surveyed businesses

Just 10% of businesses maintain cybersecurity programs that could be considered to have very high maturity.

As a business' cyber maturity increases, the likelihood of experiencing a security incident involving AI applications or models goes down significantly, from 89% (very low maturity) to 54% (very high maturity). The difference lies in those companies' priorities. Very-high-maturity companies are six times more likely to spend over 20% of their AI budget on testing security controls. These are the companies successfully addressing AI as a core component of proactive, continuous security.

It's crucial to recognize that any ROI generated by AI may be eroded by the unplanned costs of not properly preparing for an incident.

Leaders need guidance on how to build AI-ready cyber maturity and resilience. Tighter alignment between executive and security leaders can lead to a common understanding of what works to successfully secure the business.

Actionable Insights

AI can be a powerful force multiplier, but only for organizations with strong cyber foundations. Without them, the promised ROI is quickly offset by regulatory exposure, operational disruption and the unplanned costs of incident response.

- ✓ Security leaders should focus on building AI-ready resilience by strengthening core controls, establishing enterprise-wide governance and implementing continuous monitoring across AI systems.
- ✓ Make this shift through policy design, compliance testing, privacy protection and large language model/machine learning assessments.
- ✓ It's crucial to conduct ongoing risk scoring and vulnerability testing and use adaptive governance frameworks. These functions support executive decision-making, scenario planning and data-driven value creation.

These steps give company boards the confidence that AI investments are secure, compliant and strategically aligned with enterprise priorities.



5. The Path Forward: Back to Basics to Prepare for What's Next

The survey findings make clear that business and security priorities should be one and the same. While some leaders may choose to invest in advanced technology or efforts that could provide a competitive edge or an unfounded sense of security, they can't derive value from those technologies without getting the basics right first.

Going back to basics involves paying attention to the routine behind-the-scenes functions that ensure business continuity, including:

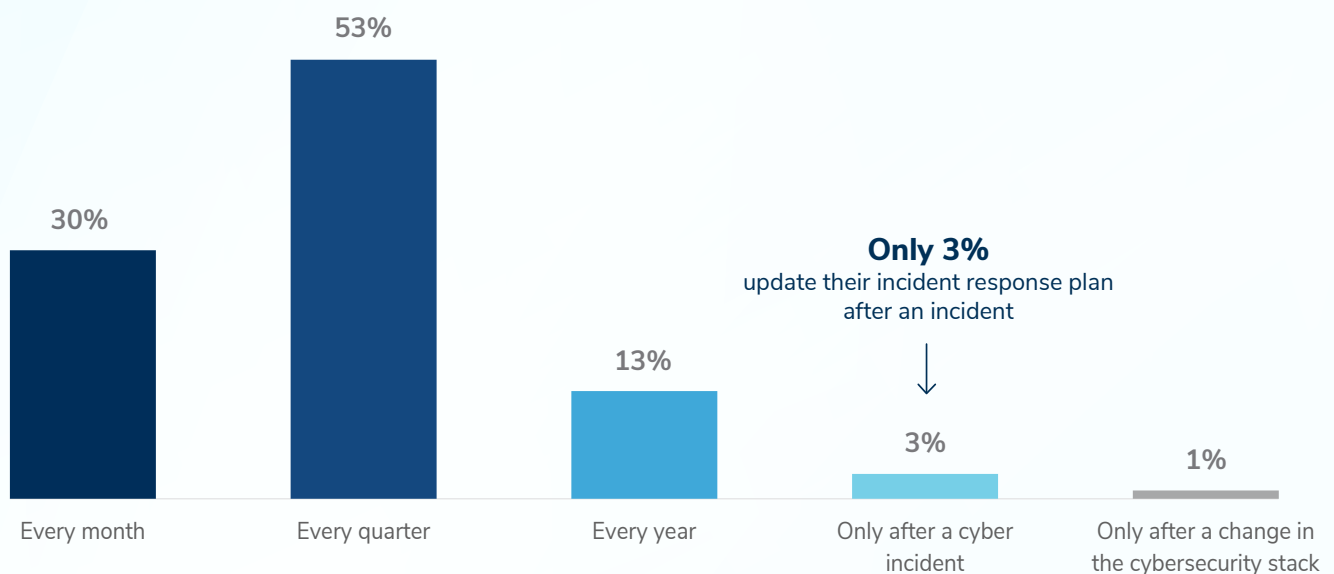
- Governance
- Visibility
- Cyber hygiene
- Incident response readiness
- Continuous testing
- Training, reinforcement and a prevention-first mindset
- Continual and cross-functional risk alignment efforts

But here's the biggest challenge to aligning security and C-suite goals: Executive spending priorities favor technology, even as the most common attacks target people, processes and the tools companies buy. An equally important task involves ensuring that response planning keeps pace with the potential impact of a cyberattack.

Incident Response Is Critical, but Many Plans Are Lacking

On the surface, preparedness looks strong: 99% of respondents state their company has an incident response plan (which is often a mandatory requirement for obtaining cyber insurance), and 83% say the company updates it monthly or quarterly.

But just 3% of survey takers said their company updates its plans after a cyber incident, possibly the most crucial time to update an incident response plan, because the company has lessons from real events. An incident response plan should be a living document, rather than just a box to check for compliance.



Base: 1000

Q. How frequently do you update your incident plan?

If a breach occurs, security teams must review and update the plan to incorporate lessons that can provide quicker, more effective responses next time. The tiny fraction of companies currently updating after an incident calls into question how often, and how well, these plans are being implemented.

The Insurance Safety Net Is Tied to Incident Response Plans

There's another essential reason to have a comprehensive, up-to-date response plan. Most insurers require one before issuing a policy. However, more than two out of every five companies lack clarity on policy requirements and payout conditions.

More than half of the respondents state their organizations have a clear understanding of what their cyber insurance covers, and those same organizations make up the 67% with advanced cyber maturity, a result of consistent execution of core security fundamentals.

44% of businesses lack clarity on their cyber insurance coverage and requirements

These fundamentals may not be high-profile initiatives, but they are essential to maintaining business continuity. They also create the foundation required for deploying AI to deliver meaningful returns: AI-enabled operations, analytics and decision-making platforms protected by AI-driven security capable of countering AI-generated threats.

Put another way, strong fundamentals are the foundation for any meaningful AI transformation.

Actionable Insights

Security leaders can achieve true cyber readiness only by doubling down on the fundamentals.

- ✓ Security fundamentals may not have the sheen of glossy new technologies, but they constitute the backbone of a mature security program. As the survey results clearly show, cyber maturity is crucial to blunting the impact of an incident.
- ✓ To close the C-suite-security team alignment gap and prepare for an AI-driven future, CISOs should adopt a life-cycle-driven approach that unifies strategy, implementation and operations.
- ✓ Establishing a firm security foundation frees up leaders to align security initiatives with business priorities, empowering them to streamline day-to-day operations across complex environments.

Together, these capabilities strengthen a business' security posture, eliminates blind spots and ensures the organization can scale and modernize securely.

Conclusion

Cybersecurity is firmly embedded in executive decision-making. Organizations are quantifying financial exposure, increasing budgets, and accelerating AI adoption across the enterprise. The survey findings, however, point to a persistent gap between intention and execution:

- Investment does not always align with the most frequent attack patterns.
 - Confidence in resilience often exceeds demonstrated recovery capability.
 - AI expansion is advancing rapidly, while governance and foundational controls mature more slowly.
- To gain ROI from AI, the basics of cybersecurity must be maintained.

Disconnects between corporate and security leadership can leave organizations vulnerable to cyberattacks that can derail business. Organizations need sustained alignment between executive oversight and the operational realities of cyber defense, positioning themselves for agility, growth and competitive advantage.

It's crucial that everyone understands the true nature of cyber risks, from downtime and recovery costs to limiting progress on new initiatives, such as going all-in on AI. It's just as important to ensure that the entire organization gets the fundamentals right, including the most appropriate technology and a security culture that engages the entire organization.

This means finding common ground between security and business priorities. CISOs and other C-suite executives can and should speak the same language. When they achieve this, security is no longer a potential hindrance to agility and revenue generation; it's an enabler.

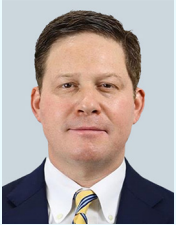
Survey methodology

The survey was conducted among 1,000 cybersecurity decision-makers who are senior manager level and above working in organizations with \$50 million+ in global annual revenue across the UK and Ireland (150), Germany (50), Switzerland (50), the U.S. (450), Japan (125), Singapore (50), Australia (25), UAE (50) and Saudi Arabia (50).

Interviews were conducted online by Sapio Research in November and December 2025 using an email invitation and an online survey. At an overall level, results are accurate to $\pm 3.1\%$ at 95% confidence limits assuming a result of 50%.



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